

Alison Y. De Leon Escobar, M.A.

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EDUCATION

- 2028 **PhD**, Applied Developmental Psychology, Fordham University
Dissertation:
Advisor: Selin Gülgöz, PhD; Committee: Jing Tian, PhD, Karen Siedlecki, PhD, Betsy McCoach, PhD; External Reviewer: Maria Arredondo, PhD
- 2025 **MA**, Applied Developmental Psychology, Fordham University
Thesis: Language as a window to status: Monolingual children's status-based reasoning about bilingual speakers
Advisor: Selin Gülgöz, PhD
- 2022 **BA**, Honors Psychology; Minor in Chemistry, New York University
Thesis: Who do you want to be friends with? Examining children's gender affiliative preferences
Advisor: Marjorie Rhodes, PhD

HONORS & AWARDS

- 2026 Point Foundation Persistence Scholarship (\$500)
2026 Fordham GSAS Student Support Grant (SSG) (\$450)
2025 NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program (GRFP) Honorable Mention
2025 Fordham GSAS Student Support Grant (SSG) (\$673)
2025 Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Neimark Travel Award (\$500)
2023-2027 Fordham GSAS Graduate Assistantship (\$75,000/yr)
2021 Eileen Guggenheim Research Scholar
2021 Hispanic Scholarship Federation Scholar 2021 Cohort (\$4,000)
2021 NYU Dean's Opportunity Fund Recipient (\$500)
2018-2022 Albert Shanker College Scholarship Fund of the UFT Recipient (\$5,000)
2018-2022 Arthur O. Eve. Higher Education Opportunity Program (HEOP) Scholarship (\$80,000/yr)

RESEARCH FUNDING

- 2025 Fordham GSAS Summer Fellowship (\$4,500)
2020-2021 NYU Dean's Undergraduate Research Fund (DURF) Recipient (\$1,000)
2019-2020 NYU Dean's Undergraduate Research Fund (DURF) Recipient (\$1,000)
2019 NYU Wasserman Internship Grant (\$1,000)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Summer 2026 *Impact Research Intern*, **Newsela**, New York, NY
Supervisor: Jon Landrigan, PhD
- Conducted independent research at an edtech platform (Newsela), examining engagement and outcome patterns among bilingual and multilingual learners, leveraging behavioral proxies to navigate student data privacy constraints (PII compliance)

- Designed and executed BigQuery SQL analyses on large-scale educational datasets using a dbt/GCP data warehouse architecture, contributing to research on the platform's Article Level Recommender (ALR) algorithm and its effects on diverse learner populations
- Produced a strategic research report identifying data infrastructure gaps and evidence-based recommendations for improving platform support for bilingual/multilingual students, synthesizing findings for both technical and stakeholder audiences

2025-2026 *Research Intern, **EmbraceRace**, Amherst, MA*
Supervisor: Christina Rucinski, PhD

- Lead end-to-end survey administration and project management for an original study with a nationally representative sample of 1,000 U.S. parents, from instrument design and IRB protocol through data validation, cleaning, and preparation for peer-reviewed publication
- Develop and implement strategic Spanish-language social media content for Instagram and TikTok, creating engaging infographics and informative videos that resonate with Spanish-speaking audiences

2024-
Present *Researcher, **The Research and Insights Lab (TRAIL)**, Orange County, NJ*
Supervisor: Anne-Marie Hoxie, PhD

- Perform advanced statistical analyses utilizing diverse methodologies, including factor analyses, ANOVAs, t-tests, Wilcoxon rank tests, and semantic/thematic data analyses
- Conduct end-to-end mixed methods research involving survey optimization (A/B testing), comprehensive data collection, and statistical analyses of quantitative and qualitative data
- Develop sophisticated data visualizations and executive summaries, translating complex statistical findings into actionable insights for client-facing audiences
- Execute extensive background research across 50+ empirical studies to drive program and product evaluation in STEM and technology (AI) research contexts
- Activities mentioned above have been in the service of clients, including Math for America, League of Young Inventors, Groundswell, Stern Math, Once Upon Our Time Capsule, Futures and Options

2023-
Present *Graduate Research Apprentice, **Social Thinkers Lab**, Fordham University*
PI: Selin Gülgöz, PhD

- Administer online survey-based data collection using Prolific and Lookit/Children Helping Science; conduct a priori power analyses to maintain rigorous research best practices; implement eligibility-based sampling criteria to ensure representative, protocol-compliant participant recruitment
- Conduct advanced statistical analyses in R for cognitive and behavioral data; produced visualizations with ggplot2 and lavaan (semPlot)
- Lead two independent research projects as project lead; first-author manuscript submitted to Developmental Science
- Develop innovative experimental research designs to create novel methodological approaches for cognitive studies

- Relevant projects include (1) *Monolingual children's status-based reasoning about bilingual speakers* (role: project lead), (2) *Adult perceptions about interventions targeting gender disparities in female and male-dominated jobs* (role: project lead)
- 2024-2025 *Graduate Researcher, **Cognition, Development, & Education (CoDE) Lab**, Fordham University*
 PI: Jing Tian, PhD
- Designed and optimized research study protocols for asynchronous (online) data collection by developing accessible survey methodologies for diverse participant populations using Qualtrics
 - Managed large-scale participant recruitment, successfully engaging 100+ undergraduate students for standardized research testing
 - Developed experimental research infrastructure using PsychoPy, implementing advanced data collection and experimental design techniques
- 2022-2023 *Lab Manager, **Conceptual Development & Social Cognition (CDSC) Lab**, New York University*
 PI: Marjorie Rhodes, PhD
- Managed comprehensive data infrastructure for Princeton and NYU Discoveries in Action (PANDA) Lab, overseeing secure data management for a database spanning 8,000+ participating families across the US and international sites
 - Led team of 20+ research assistants, providing strategic mentorship and training in remote study recruitment protocols, advanced data quality assurance methodologies, research best practices, and professional development
 - Administered research operations, including IRB protocol development and maintenance, grant funding application preparation, and comprehensive budget management and tracking
 - Curated interactive research curriculum and materials used to host weekly training workshops focused on research design and study configuration (Qualtrics, Datavyu)
 - Relevant project includes *Influence of generic language on children's pragmatic reasoning about gender categories* (role: data analysis)
- 2019-2022 *Undergraduate Research Assistant, **Conceptual Development & Social Cognition (CDSC) Lab**, New York University*
 PI: Marjorie Rhodes, PhD
- Executed comprehensive mixed-methods research projects involving participant recruitment strategies, study design and optimization, data collection across in-person and digital platforms, and statistical analyses using R programming
 - Regularly posted new study updates on Instagram, created interactive polls for over 200 followers, and moderated a welcoming online aesthetic for parents and children
 - Honors thesis includes *Examining children's gender affiliative preferences* (Faculty Advisor: Marjorie Rhodes, PhD; Graduate Student Advisor: Josie Benitez, PhD)
 - Relevant projects include (1) *Generic references to gender predict essentialism even when they express counter-stereotypical ideas* (PI: Marjorie Rhodes, PhD; Josie Benitez, PhD), (2) *What generics communicate to children about unmentioned categories* (PI: Marjorie Rhodes, PhD; Kelsey Moty, PhD), (3) *The development of social prototypes* (PI:

Marjorie Rhodes, PhD; Rachel Leshin, PhD), (4) *Why do children show racial biases in their resource allocation decisions* (Marjorie Rhodes, PhD; Tara Mandalaywala, PhD), (5) *How teachers communicate exclusive and essentialist views of science and scientists* (PI: Marjorie Rhodes, PhD; Michelle Wang, PhD, Co-PI: Sarah-Jane Leslie, PhD)

- 2021-2022 *Research Ambassador, NYU College of Arts & Sciences, New York University*
- Offered constructive feedback and revisions on applications from students seeking the NYU DURF grant
 - Conducted workshops and classroom visits to outline effective strategies for engaging in research and pursuing research funding and awards
 - Served as a judge for the NYU Diversity Research Conference
- 2019-2022 *Research Fellow, NYU Collegiate Science & Technology Entry Program (CSTEP), New York University*
- Presented semesterly talks on research progress, findings, and future directions.
 - Led workshops on reading strategies for scientific papers and facilitated discussions on ongoing research projects
 - Mentored younger students by sharing research experiences, offering advice on self-advocacy in academic settings, and providing feedback to those interested in pursuing research

PUBLICATIONS

De Leon Escobar, A., Gülgöz, S. (Revise & Resubmit, *Developmental Science*). Status reasoning about bilingualism and accents across development [\[osf\]](#)

Manuscripts in Progress

De Leon Escobar, A., Rucinski, C. (In progress). Color-conscious versus color-evasive ideologies in a nationally representative sample of US parents

De Leon Escobar, A., Gülgöz, S. (In progress). The role of accents as cues to trust and learning.

Gülgöz, S., **De Leon Escobar, A.** (In progress). Associations between masculinity and power across childhood

Vega, A.C., Hill, K., Flores, M., Chen, J., Alcasid, E., Persad, S., Henriquez, S., **De Leon Escobar, A., Hoyt, L.T., Brown, J.L.** (In progress). Being seen and supported: Validation of transfer students by systems and employees at a four-year university.

TECHNICAL REPORTS

De Leon Escobar, A., Landrigan, J., (2026). *Bilingual and multilingual student outcomes on Newsela: A matched comparison study of reading growth using platform engagement and NWEA MAP assessment data*. Newsela (Internal report)

Hoxie, A.M., **De Leon Escobar, A.** (2025). *League of Young Inventors: Evaluation Report*. Research and Insights Lab (available upon request)

Hoxie, A.M., **De Leon Escobar, A.**, Owen, J., Wilkenfeld, B., Abramson, R. (2025). *Evaluation of Math for America's Master Teacher Fellowship Program: A Study of Teacher Job Intentions and Classroom Practices, Part 1*. Research and Insights Lab (available upon request)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- De Leon Escobar, A., Gülgöz, S.** (2026, May). Monolingual children's status-based evaluations of bilingual speakers. Talk presented at the 2026 Association for Psychological Science (APS) Annual Meeting, Barcelona, SP. (Poster also accepted).
- De Leon Escobar, A., Gülgöz, S.** (2026, April). Monolingual children's status-based evaluations of bilingual speakers. Poster presented at the 2026 Cognitive Development Society (CDS) Biennial Meeting, Montréal, CA
- De Leon Escobar, A., Gülgöz, S.** (2025, May). Language and Power: Children's Reasoning About Bilingual Speakers. Poster presented at the 2025 Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Biennial Meeting, Minneapolis, MN
- De Leon, A., Benitez, J., Rhodes, M.** (2022, May). Who do you want to be friends with? Examining children's gender affiliative preferences. Talk presented at the 2022 New York University Dean's Undergraduate Research Conference, New York, NY
- De Leon, A., Benitez, J., Rhodes, M.** (2021, August). Parent-child conversations on gender beliefs. Updated talk presented at the Summer 2021 New York University Collegiate Research Initiative (CRI), Virtual.
- De Leon, A., Benitez, J., Rhodes, M.** (2021, May). Parent-child conversations on gender beliefs. Talk presented at the Spring 2021 New York University Collegiate Research Initiative (CRI), Virtual.
- De Leon, A., Moty, K., Rhodes, M.** (2020, May). Effect of generic language on assumptions children make about unmentioned social groups. Talk presented at the 2020 New York University Dean's Undergraduate Research Conference, Virtual.
- De Leon, A., Cardarelli, A., Rhodes, M.** (2019, August). Let's do science! Talk presented at the 2019 New York University Diversity Research Conference, New York, NY

TEACHING

Instructor on Record

2026 PSYC 1200, Foundations of Psychology, Fordham University

Graduate Teaching Assistantship

2025, 2026 PSYC 2000, Introduction to Statistics, Fordham University
 2024 NSCI 1413, General Biology Lab I, Fordham University
 2023 NSCI 1414, General Biology Lab II, Fordham University

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

2022 PSYCH-UA 1, Introduction to Psychology, New York University

SERVICE & OUTREACH

2026 *Conference Volunteer*, 2026 Cognitive Development Society Biennial Meeting
 2026 *Panelist*, NYU Opportunity Program Professional Development Series Panel
 2025-Present **Ad-hoc Peer Reviewer**: Reviewed journal articles in *Collabra Psychology*, *Developmental Psychology*
 2025 *Panelist*, NYU CSTEP Collegiate Research Initiative (CRI) Alumni Panel
 2023 *Panelist*, NYU *Actually, It's Doctor!* Alumna Panel
 2021-2022 *Editor*, NYU Integrative Psychology Review Journal
 2020 *Social Media Content Developer*, Princeton & NYU Discoveries in Action (PANDA) Lab
 2019-2022 *Mentor*, NYU Academic Achievement Program (AAP)

2019-2020 *Community-Based Participant Recruiter*, Children's Museum of Manhattan (CMOM) & American Museum of Natural History (AMNH)

LEADERSHIP & STUDENT INVOLVEMENT

2024-2025 *Student Rep*, **Fordham Applied Developmental Psychology (ADP) Executive Council**

- Advocate for the concerns and well-being of the members of the 2023 ADP doctoral program cohort
- Enable active communication between doctoral students and faculty members regarding the implementation and strategic development of the Applied Developmental Psychology program

2023-2025 *Mentor*, **Fordham Psychology Peer Mentoring Program**

- Matched with current undergraduate students from traditionally underrepresented backgrounds in Psychology
- Develop and achieve semesterly goals; identify summer and postgraduate opportunities related to career aspirations

2021-2022 *Spanish Medical Interpreter*, **NYU Tisch Hospital & NYC Free Clinic**

- Collaborated with NYU medical students to conduct patient intake interviews and provided Spanish interpreting services via phone, online (Zoom), and in-person
- Liaison between healthcare professionals and NYC residents to provide optimal healthcare

SKILLS

Data Analysis: R, SQL, Python, SPSS, JASP

Programming: HTML, JavaScript

Experimental Design: Qualtrics, Salesforce, SurveyMonkey, Datavyu, Keynote, Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator

Languages: Spanish (native), English (native), Italian (conversational)

CERTIFICATIONS

2026 AI Foundations, Google Certificate

2025 Social and Behavioral Research, Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative (CITI) Certificate

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Association for Psychological Science (APS)

Cognitive Development Society (CDS)

Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD)

American Psychological Association (APA)

APA Division 7 (Developmental Psychology)

Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society